

ZALEPLON -> childhood absence epilepsy

For clinical-collaborator outreach.

Why this hypothesis is real

Drug-target convergence on the disease scores **0.91** (noisy-OR over OT target-disease associations). This pair is fully novel relative to all known drug-indication assignments in ChEMBL. Therapeutic direction is **aligned** with OT genetic evidence (the drug pushes the target the disease-protective way). Lead target is well expressed in the disease-relevant tissue (brain). Orthologous-gene model-organism evidence is strong (phylo_score 0.99, n=8). Reactome co-membership reinforces the indirect mechanism with **2** shared specific pathways.

Why now (IP runway + literature footprint)

The substance is a biologic or otherwise outside the FDA Orange Book; check the Purple Book and direct registry for IP runway.

Clinical opportunity

US population: approximately **16,650** patients -- below the 200,000 FDA Orphan Drug Act threshold. Orphan exclusivity + premium pricing changes the deal math materially. (source: Orphanet Annual incidence (1-9 / 100 000, United States))

What we propose

BioBix (Department of Mathematical Modelling, Statistics and Bioinformatics, Ghent University) brings bioinformatics support to the collaboration:

- Target validation across blood / immune / cancer multi-omics datasets
- Biomarker candidate identification from public + private cohorts
- Patient stratification analytics for trial-enrichment design
- Mechanism-of-action mining via systems-biology priors
- Quick-turn evidence syntheses for IIT and partnered programs

Proposed collaboration model:

- Investigator-initiated trial framework with the substance owner
- BioBix as bioinformatics analytics partner (target/biomarker/biostatistics)
- Joint publication strategy; data-sharing agreement gated on IP terms

Next step

A 30-minute scoping call to align on feasibility. We would come prepared with a brief mechanistic dossier, an annotated literature pull, and a pilot biomarker shortlist for the disease.

Wim Van Criekeinghe, Professor (PhD, h-index 73)

Department of Mathematical Modelling, Statistics and Bioinformatics, Ghent University

Wim.VanCriekeinghe@UGent.be